

Hanover Research supports faculty at West Chester University of Pennsylvania in creating new programs that are aligned with regional needs to sustain the institution's competitive academic program mix.



LAUNCHING A DOCTOR OF PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION PROGRAM

PROGRAM APPROVAL PROCESS

1. **HYPOTHESIS** – Demand exists for senior non-profit executives to acquire a terminal degree
2. **ASSUMPTION** – Limited competition exists for developing a new Doctor of Public Administration (DPA) degree program
3. **CONFIRMATION** – Commission **Hanover Research** to validate labor market outlook and employer needs for DPA credentials
4. **REVIEW** – Share Hanover findings with faculty and department chairs, the provost, and president to inform the program's future direction
5. **DECISION** – Determine positive outlook exists to proceed with program development
6. **PROPOSAL** – Insert Hanover's labor market and student demand data into program proposal
7. **APPROVAL** – Submit proposal to the Pennsylvania State System of Higher Education (PASSHE), Board of Governors, and Middle States Commission to gain approval and accreditation
8. **LAUNCH** – Effective fall 2015, West Chester University of Pennsylvania will offer an entirely online DPA program
9. **VALIDATION** – Influx of initial student interest confirms program attractiveness
10. **FUTURE DIRECTION** – West Chester University will build a center of excellence around the DPA program, as it will be one of only four accredited terminal public administration degrees in the nation

MARKET EXPLORATION CONTRIBUTIONS

Hanover provides market insight...

- ✓ Assessed program demand
- ✓ Examined industry trends
- ✓ Gauged labor market outlook
- ✓ Reviewed regional competitors

...that helps West Chester identify unmet education needs...

- ✓ Confirmed market growth
- ✓ Validated positive employment outlook
- ✓ Defined the competitive landscape
- ✓ Identified factors of competitive tuition pricing and program differentiation

...in a manner that maximizes its administrators' efficiency.

- ✓ Adapted partnership cadence for West Chester to commission project priorities in bulk in accordance with its internal program evaluation process



"Our institution has a mission-driven obligation to meet the needs of the commonwealth of Pennsylvania and the people within. **As we do not have staff dedicated to market research, Hanover is a critical resource for us to access the bandwidth, resources, and capacity required to understand and respond to those needs.**"

- Dr. Jeffery L. Osgood, Jr.

Associate Provost and Dean of Graduate Studies (interim)

For more information regarding this case study, contact info@hanoverresearch.com